

Active Directory Lab – Part 5: Domain Client Join and Account Lockout Investigation

Objective

The objective of this lab was to join a Windows 11 client machine to the adlab.local domain and test domain authentication. This included logging in as a domain user, confirming the client computer appeared in Active Directory, testing account lockout behaviour, and reviewing related Windows Security events.

Lab Environment

This part of the lab used the Windows Server domain controller and a Windows 11 client virtual machine. The Windows 11 client was connected to the same host-only lab network as the domain controller and was configured to use the domain controller for DNS.

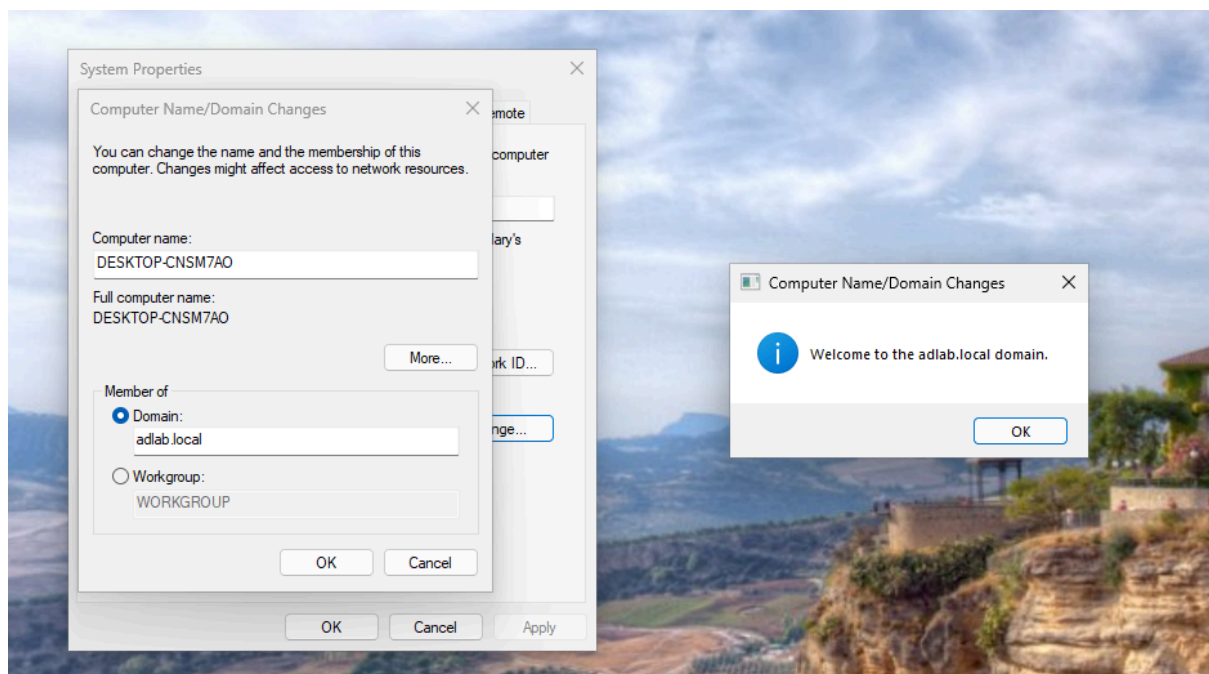
The domain used for this lab was adlab.local.

Tools Used:

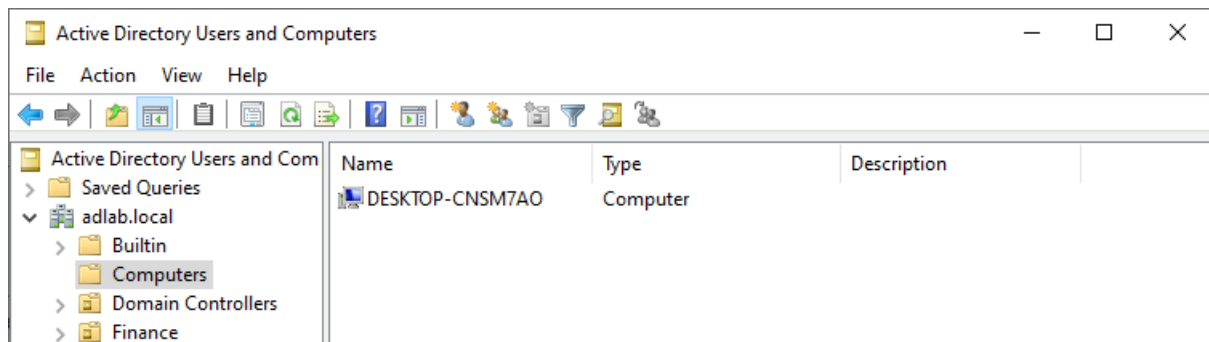
- Windows Server 2022 Evaluation
- Windows 11
- Active Directory Users and Computers
- Event Viewer
- Command Prompt
- Group Policy

Steps Performed

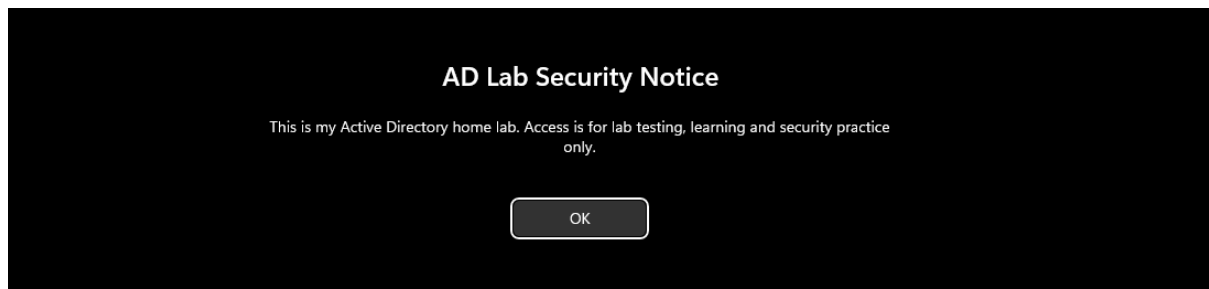
The Windows 11 client was configured to communicate with the domain controller on the host-only lab network. After DNS was configured correctly, the client was joined to the adlab.local domain.



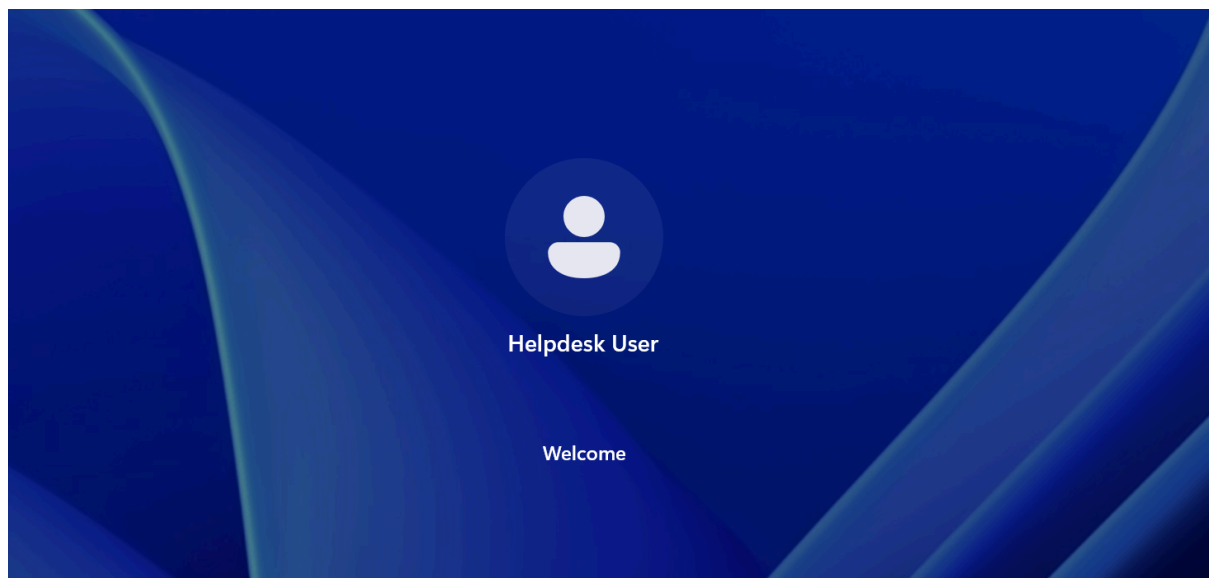
After the domain join completed, the client computer object appeared in Active Directory Users and Computers under the default Computers container. This confirmed that the Windows 11 machine had joined the domain successfully.



The Windows 11 client was then restarted and tested with a domain user account. The login banner configured in Part 4 appeared before sign-in, showing that the Group Policy setting had applied to the client machine.



The Helpdesk User domain account was used to log in to the Windows 11 client.



Command Prompt was used to confirm the logged-in user. The whoami command showed that the session was running as adlab\helpdesk.user

```
C:\ Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26200.6584]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

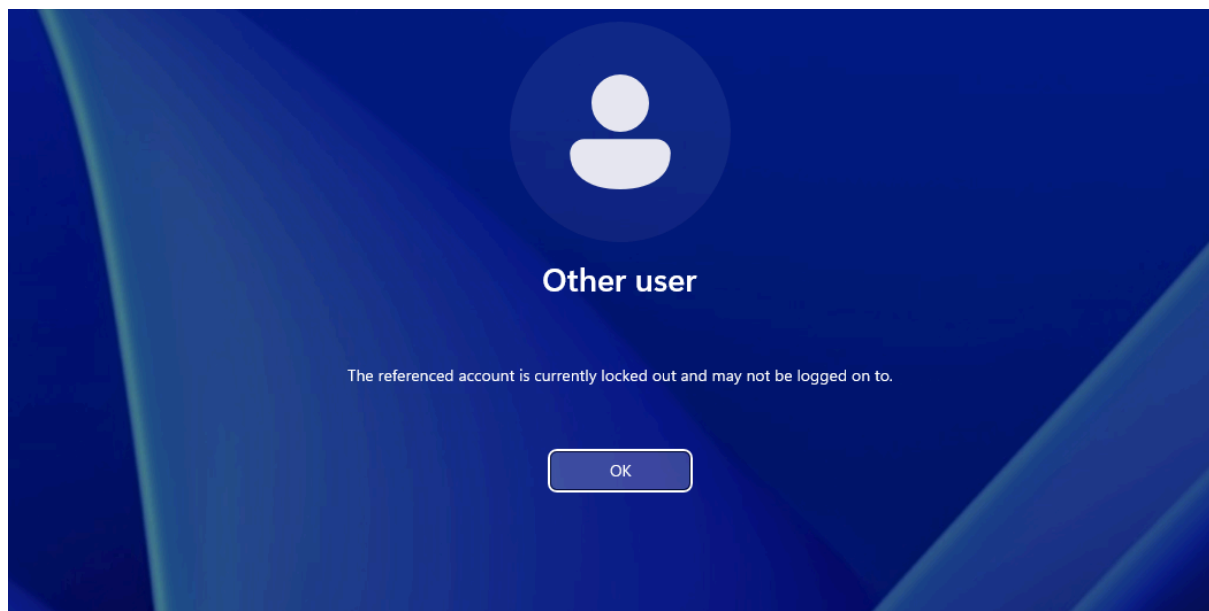
C:\Users\helpdesk.user>whoami
adlab\helpdesk.user

C:\Users\helpdesk.user>
```

The account lockout policy was verified using Command Prompt. The “net accounts /domain” command showed a lockout threshold of 5 invalid logon attempts, a lockout duration of 30 minutes, and a lockout observation window of 30 minutes.

```
C:\Users\Administrator>net accounts /domain
Force user logoff how long after time expires?: Never
Minimum password age (days): 1
Maximum password age (days): 42
Minimum password length: 7
Length of password history maintained: 24
Lockout threshold: 5
Lockout duration (minutes): 30
Lockout observation window (minutes): 30
Computer role: PRIMARY
The command completed successfully.
```

A failed login test was then performed using the “jsmith” domain account. After repeated incorrect password attempts, the Windows 11 client displayed a message stating that the account was locked out.



The lockout was also confirmed in Active Directory Users and Computers. The John Smith account showed that it was currently locked out on the domain controller.

John Smith Properties

Member Of: Remote control, Dial-in, Environment, Sessions, Remote Desktop Services Profile, COM+

General Address Account Profile Telephones Organization

User logon name: smith @adlab.local

User logon name (pre-Windows 2000): ADLAB\smith

Logon Hours... Log On To...

☒ Unlock account. This account is currently locked out on this Active Directory Domain Controller.

Account options:

- ☐ User must change password at next logon
- ☐ User cannot change password
- ☒ Password never expires
- ☐ Store password using reversible encryption

Account expires

☒ Never

☐ End of: Thursday, August 20, 2026

OK Cancel Apply Help

Event Viewer was then used to review the Windows Security logs on the domain controller. Event ID 4625 showed a failed logon attempt from the Windows 11 client.

Event Viewer

File Action View Help

Event Viewer (Local)

- Custom Views
- Windows Logs
 - Application
 - Security
 - Setup
 - System
- Forwarded Events
- Applications and Services Logs
- Subscriptions

Security Number of events: 4,399

Filtered: Log: Security; Source: ; Event ID: 4625. Number of events: 1

Keywords	Date and Time	Source	Event ID	Task Category
Audit Failure	7/21/2026 8:24:50 AM	Microsoft Windows security a...	4625	Logon

Event 4625, Microsoft Windows security auditing.

General Details

Security ID: NULL SID

Account Name: -

Account Domain: -

Logon ID: 0x0

Logon Type: 3

Account For Which Logon Failed:

Security ID: NULL SID

Account Name: LabAdmin2026

Account Domain: adlab.local

Failure Information:

Failure Reason: Unknown user name or bad password.

Status: 0xC000006D

Sub Status: 0xC0000064

Process Information:

Caller Process ID: 0x0

Caller Process Name: -

Network Information:

Workstation Name: DESKTOP-CNSM7AO

Source Network Address: 192.168.56.20

Source Port: 50000

Detailed Authentication Information:

Log Name: Security

Source: Microsoft Windows security

Event ID: 4625

Level: Information

User: N/A

OpCode: Info

More Information: [Event Log Online Help](#)

Logged: 7/21/2026 8:24:50 AM

Task Category: Logon

Keywords: Audit Failure

Computer: AD-DC-1.adlab.local

Creates a filter.

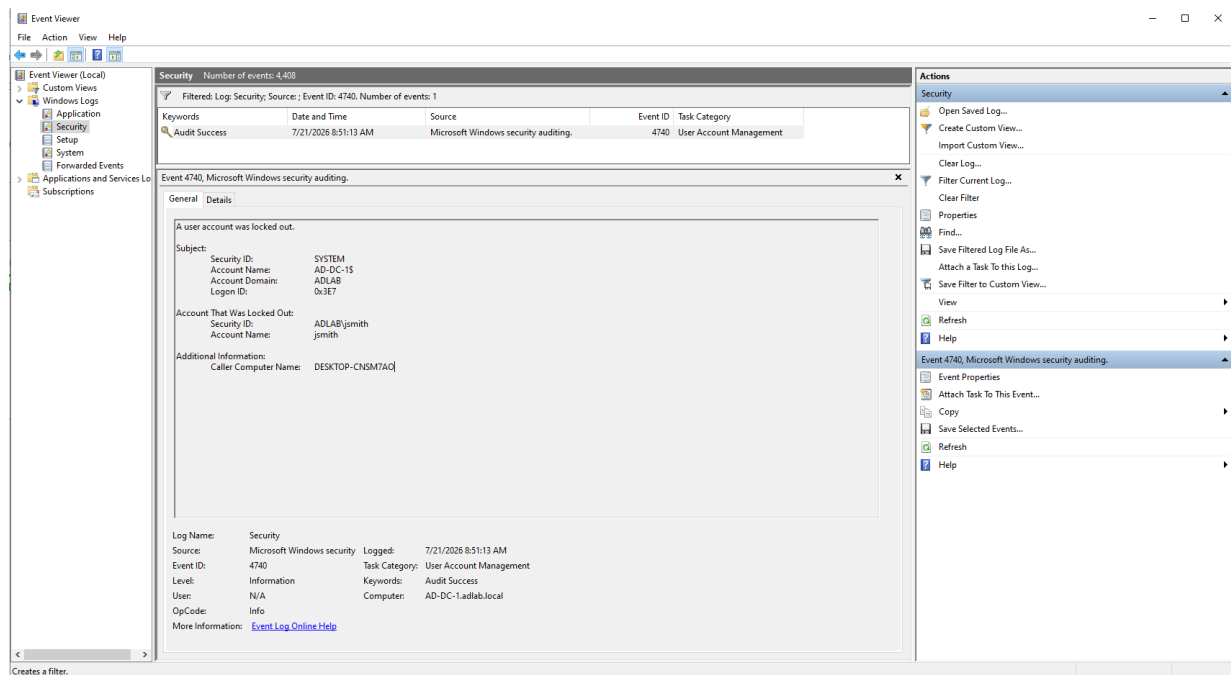
Actions

- Security
- Open Saved Log...
- Create Custom View...
- Import Custom View...
- Clear Log...
- Filter Current Log...
- Clear Filter
- Properties
- Find...
- Save Filtered Log File As...
- Attach a Task To This Log...
- Save Filter to Custom View...
- View
- Refresh
- Help

Event 4625, Microsoft Windows security auditing.

- Event Properties
- Attach Task To This Event...
- Copy
- Save Selected Events...
- Refresh
- Help

Event ID 4740 showed that the jsmith account had been locked out. The event also showed the caller computer name as the Windows 11 client.



Findings

The Windows 11 client successfully joined the adlab.local domain and appeared as a computer object in Active Directory. A domain user was able to log in successfully, and the “whoami” command confirmed the authenticated domain account.

The login banner policy applied to the client machine, showing that Group Policy was working beyond the domain controller itself.

The account lockout test was also successful. After repeated failed login attempts, the domain account was locked out, Active Directory showed the locked account status, and Event Viewer recorded the failed logon and account lockout events.

Conclusion

This part of the lab demonstrated a full domain client workflow in an Active Directory environment. A Windows 11 client was joined to the domain, a domain user login was tested, Group Policy was confirmed on the client, and an account lockout investigation was performed using Active Directory Users and Computers and Event Viewer. This lab covered common Active Directory administration and troubleshooting tasks, including domain joining, user authentication, account lockout verification, and Windows Security log review.